

MEGHALAYA ENTERPRISE ARCHITECTURE

Meghalaya's Planning Department's key initiative of e-Proposal System, part of Meghalaya Enterprise Architecture (MeghEA) won the coveted UN Award World Summit on the Information Society Forum (WSIS) Prizes 2022.

50 DEPARTMENTS

70 DIRECTORATES

1,100 DDOS

are party of MeghEA

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prosperity of farmers, skill development, youth and child welfare, connectivity, tourism, and hospitality.

The decisive leadership of the chief minister left a mark in every domain—from generating external financial assistance to solving border disputes with neighbouring states. Multiple external agencies showed faith in Chief Minister Conrad Sangma's vision for Meghalaya and consequently the state witnessed a three-fold increase in external financing touching Rs 7,886.5 crore. He also did not hesitate to sit for candid and transparent dialogue with Assam Chief Minister Dr Himanta Biswa Sarma over six out of 12 disputed border areas. These initiatives are bound to bring results sooner than expected.

Following the historic 2019 judgement by Supreme Court upholding the rights of tribal people over the land and minerals, mining has once again resumed in the state, bringing back livelihood opportunities to many in Meghalaya. The state government is taking all possible measures to encourage and ensure scientific mining.

The good news did not end there. Conrad Sangma genuinely believes that there is a huge potential for international trade between Meghalaya and neighbouring country Bangladesh. As a leader who steers clear of rhetoric and believe in walking the talk, he became the first Meghalaya chief minister to visit Jaintapur, an ancient kingdom, now a sub-division in Bangladesh. During his four-day-long tour to Bangladesh in 2019, Conrad Sangma also called on Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina in Dhaka and talked at length on several issues concerning Meghalaya and Bangladesh.

While Conrad Sangma-led Meghalaya Democratic Alliance has completed four years in power, the chief minister has no time to celebrate and pause. The road is long, and the state is burdened with a legacy of historical underperformance and political mismanagement. That makes the accomplishments of last four years even more significant.

But Conrad Sangma is in no mood to claim credit yet. He sees this spike in the developmental curve of the state as a collective achievement of the people of Meghalaya. "I want to thank all our citizens for their support and contributions in building Meghalaya. I feel proud to be leading this amazing journey of building Meghalaya as a vibrant, caring, robust economy and society," he says. ■

The Big Spend

Conrad Sangma's government has increased the average state expenditure by 48.7 per cent in last four years compared to the period between 2014 and 2018